Bow Valley College

Course Outline

NURS9316

Enhancing Communication Skills in Registered Nursing

Winter 2025 - Current

Last Updated: 9/26/2024 9:13:43 AM

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NURS9316 Enhancing Communication Skills in Registered Nursing

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This Micro Credential focuses on exploring communication techniques, emphasizing patient and family-centered approaches that promote trust, empathy, and understanding to assess and respond to patient needs effectively. Nurses will learn to communicate sensitively and respectfully with patients who may be vulnerable by fostering a safe and supportive environment. This Micro Credential will also aid to develop nurses skills in collaborating with other health professionals, building autonomy, and working in non-hierarchical team structures within the Canadian Health Care system to optimize patient care outcomes.

REQUISITES	None
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	0
HOURS	42
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	No
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	Yes

COURSE COMPETENCY

COMPETENCY TITLE

Enhancing Communication Skills in Registered Nursing

COMPETENCY STATEMENT

Nurses will demonstrate the ability to utilize patient and family-centered communication techniques that foster trust, empathy, and collaboration, while working effectively in non-hierarchical team structures to optimize patient care outcomes.

COMPETENCY DESCRIPTION

This Micro Credential emphasizes the importance of communication skills in delivering patient-centered care that is both respectful and responsive to the needs of patients and their families. Nurses will learn to employ techniques that promote empathy, trust, and understanding, particularly when interacting with vulnerable populations. By creating a safe and supportive environment through thoughtful communication, nurses can assess and respond more effectively to patient needs. Additionally, this Micro Credential highlights the nurse's role in collaborating with other healthcare professionals, fostering autonomy, and working within non-hierarchical team structures. These skills are essential for ensuring that care is coordinated and optimized, leading to improved patient outcomes in Alberta's healthcare system.

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong learners. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that learners acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1.	Demonstrate interprofessional communication with team members to ensure safe and comprehensive patient care	1,2,4,5,6,7,8,9
2.	Utilize strategies to overcome barriers to promote effective communication	1,2,4,5,6,7,8,9
3.	Demonstrate strategies to effectively communicate with the patient and family as the center of the healthcare team	1,2,4,5,6,7,8,9
4.	Demonstrate strategies to effectively communicate with the patient and family as the center of the healthcare team	1,2,4,5,6,7,8,9

LEARNING PATHWAY

**The time it takes learners to demonstrate competencies will vary. An example of a suggested schedule for learning and development is shown below. Learners will need to plan out their assessment attempts within their course. For additional information, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	LEARNING AND DEVELOPMENT PLAN
Week 1	Module 1: Foundations for Effective Communication
Week 2	Module 2: Communicating with the Patient and Family as the Center of the Healthcare Team
Week 3	Module 2: Communicating with the Patient and Family as the Center of the Healthcare Team
Week 4	Module 2: Communicating with the Patient and Family as the Center of the Healthcare Team
Week 5	Module 3: Interprofessional Communication with Team Members
Week 6	Module 3: Interprofessional Communication with Team Members
Week 7	Module 4: Documentation Practices
Week 8	Assessment

ASSESSMENT

This course follows an assessment-first approach, in which learners will be assessed, and receive structured feedback, and a personalized learning plan. Learners will also receive differentiated support from an instructor based on their individual needs.

Learners will have a variety of ways to demonstrate they have met the required competency through the demonstration of learning outcomes and criteria as laid out in the rubric. Learners will have multiple (but not unlimited) attempts to prove competency. It is suggested that learners plan out their assessment attempts within their course.

Learners will have flexibility in how they satisfy course learning outcomes while still adhering to the criteria found in the rubric and the Course Offering information. Please refer to the Course Offering Information and the rubric in Brightspace for additional information.

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES	ASSESSMENT
1. Demonstrate interprofessional communication with team members to ensure safe and comprehensive patient care	Patient Education Activity and Team Communication Case Study
2. Utilize strategies to overcome barriers to promote effective communication	Patient Education Activity
3. Demonstrate strategies to effectively communicate with the patient and family as the center of the healthcare team	Team Communication Case Study
4. Demonstrate strategies to effectively communicate with the patient and family as the center of the healthcare team	Documentation Assignment

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

GRADING SCHEME

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Learners with a disability (learning, physical, and/or mental health) may qualify for academic and exam accommodations. For more information, or to apply for accommodations, learners should make an appointment with Accessibility Services in the Learner Success Services (LSS) Department. Accessibility Services can also assist learners who may be struggling with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. To make an appointment visit LSS on the first floor of the south campus or call 403-410-1440. It is the learner's responsibility to contact Accessibility Services and request academic accommodations. For more information, please visit our website at http://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/accessibility.

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Learners are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Learner Code of Conduct, Procedures and Guidelines (500-1-1), Learner Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1-10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13). Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by learners is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student papers. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described

on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, bowvalleycollege.ca.

Learners are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course section. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements.

You may use the recordings only for educational purposes and you must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission.

Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 33(c) of the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (Alberta) to deliver academic programming, support learner flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. If you have any questions about the collection, disclosure, use, or protection of this information, please contact the College's Access and Privacy Officer at foip@bowvalleycollege.ca.